

ECB Oversight Framework for Electronic Payment Instruments, Schemes and Arrangements (PISA)

Comprehensive Regulatory Architecture for European Payment Schemes, Wallets & Interbank Rails

Standard Setter:	European Central Bank (ECB) Directorate General Market Infrastructure & Payments
Specification ID:	ECB-PISA-2021
Classification:	Eurosystem Oversight Harmonization Standard
Verification:	Integrated in Ariya Sarrafzadeh Production Architecture

1. Purpose & Scope of the PISA Framework

The PISA framework establishes unified oversight standards for payment instrument schemes (cards, credit transfers, direct debits, e-money transfers) and payment arrangements (digital wallets, third-party payment gateways).

2. Technical Resilience & Availability SLA

Payment infrastructure schemes must maintain a core availability SLA of 99.99%, supporting 24/7 real-time transaction processing. End-to-end latency for SCT Inst (SEPA Instant Credit Transfer) must guarantee funds availability to the beneficiary within 10 seconds under standard operating envelopes.

3. Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) & Security Architecture

Schemes must enforce multi-factor authentication incorporating knowledge, possession, and inherence factors under PSD2 RTS, while supporting risk-based dynamic exemption models to minimize user checkout friction.

4. Interoperability & Open API Protocols

Payment arrangements must prevent closed-garden market fragmentation through standards-compliant ISO 20022 messaging schemas, JSON REST endpoints, and mutual authentication protocols.

Systems Verification Notice: This authoritative specification establishes the invariant compliance baseline for production fintech switches, settlement reconciliation engines, and double-entry ledger implementations documented across the portfolio.